RipoDoc Brutal Audit B

Controlled Evidence-Delivery Expansion and YC-Readiness

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1 Executive verdict

A bounded RipoDoc expansion can strengthen the company. A broad expansion will destroy its clarity. The only credible adjacent direction is to deepen controlled evidence delivery—from a proof view into an accountable delivery operation—while refusing to become a general client portal, full QBR suite, generic data room, generic file repository, or autonomous compliance authority.

The current expansion thesis is strategically coherent because it follows the user's existing report workflow instead of trying to replace the tools already used for PSA, RMM, BI, QBR preparation, ticketing, planning, and client collaboration. Broad MSP platforms already own most of that surface. 1 2 3 4

The decision is not whether more features are possible. They are. The decision is whether every new capability reinforces one core sentence:

> **RipoDoc gives an MSP a controlled, reviewed, recipient-aware answer when a client asks for proof behind a report claim.**

1.1 Expansion verdict

Expansion direction	Decision	Why
Evidence Delivery Receipt and lifecycle roster	Build next	Directly strengthens issuance, expiry, access, revocation, reissue, and accountability around an evidence delivery.
Tenant-scoped delivery policy	Build after receipt	Makes existing security controls operational rather than one-off; supports the recipient and expiry promise.
Signed event webhooks	Build behind guardrails	Lets MSPs connect delivery outcomes to existing PSA/CRM workflows without exporting evidence rows.
Authoritative source maps and connector refresh	Validate before build	High customer value but integration complexity and source-trust risk are substantial.
AI-assisted claim/evidence drafting	Later, human-review only	Potential productivity gain; unsafe if it turns unreviewed AI output into report authority.
Generic portal, ticketing, budgets, dashboards, knowledge base	Do not build	This would enter crowded markets with weaker differentiation and worse focus.
Generic secure data room	Do not build	DocSend-like products already own broad document controls; RipoDoc should keep the claim-level proof boundary.

2 Why the wedge can matter

2.1 The market is crowded, but the boundary is not empty

ScalePad markets AI-powered QBR automation, data aggregation across more than 45 tools, standardised QBRs, recommendations, and action planning. 1 CloudRadial markets client dashboards, policy reporting, vCIO planning, and on-demand QBRs. 2 Strategy Overview and MSP Report Card market broad client

portals and relationship operations including assets, tickets, budgets, plans, assessments, reporting, and QBRs. 3 4

Those products make QBRs easier to prepare or broader information easier to access. They do not, from their public positioning, establish RipoDoc's exact reader-level proposition: **the evidence view is deliberately narrow, comes after a human review boundary, is recipient-aware, expires, can be revoked, and explains what one selected claim does and does not prove.** That is a viable wedge only if it produces an outcome MSPs care about: faster answers, fewer broad exports, less risk from over-sharing, or more confidence in client decisions.

DocSend illustrates the secure-document expectation floor: recipient verification, passcodes, expiry, view/download policy, dynamic watermarking, individual links, revocation, and access logs. 5 RipoDoc should borrow the **control patterns**, not the generic-file business model.

2.2 Demand hypothesis: plausible, unproven

MSP guidance supports the core workflow. NinjaOne recommends concise QBR structures, a small business-focused KPI set, executive summaries, and translation of technical data into business outcomes from PSA/RMM reporting. 6 A public MSP practitioner described seeking quarterly reports that make background activity visible to clients. 7

That is not enough to claim demand for RipoDoc. The falsifiable demand hypothesis is narrower:

> **When a report contains a material uptime, backup, patching, risk, cost, or service-performance claim, a qualified MSP will pay to replace an unrestricted raw export with a reviewed, limited, recipient-specific evidence path—and will use it again in the next reporting cycle.**

If five MSPs will not run this more than once after seeing a working pilot, the product is a feature rather than a company.

3 The bounded expansion roadmap

3.1 Stage 0: unblock the product before enlarging it

No expansion work substitutes for the current production-readiness gap. First configure a non-demo environment: database, migrations, authentication, canonical origin, email, CAPTCHA, durable audit backend, private worker, founder intake, monitoring, backup/restore, and operator runbook. The live health endpoint presently reports these services as unconfigured. 8

3.2 Stage 1: Evidence Delivery Receipt — the highest-leverage next feature

The first expansion should be a first-class evidence delivery receipt (delivery receipt). A receipt is not analytics theatre. It is the durable operator record for a delivery issuance and its lifecycle.

Record fact	Required boundary
Report and claim identifiers	Immutable report/version and element identifiers; no mutable report reconstruction.

Record fact	Required boundary
Evidence provenance	Reviewed source, capture time, reviewer, scope statement, and manifest hash.
Recipient reference	Hash or encrypted protected identifier; never a raw address in broad operator analytics.
Policy facts	Issue time, expiry, delivery mode, revoke/reissue history, optional watermark/export policy.
Access result	Granted, denied, expired, revoked, or error outcome; avoid collecting unnecessary viewing telemetry.
Integrity	Append-only or integrity-chained storage with tenant isolation and retention policy.

Acceptance test: an operator can answer "what did we send, to whom under which policy, what proof did it contain, and what happened?" without opening the evidence rows or guessing from logs.

3.3 Stage 2: Tenant-scoped delivery policy

Build a evidence-delivery policy (delivery policy) only after the receipt model exists. The policy must be tenant-scoped, versioned, and explicit about defaults. Required controls are recipient binding, max TTL, revocation authority, optional reissue, optional watermark / view-only behaviour, safe event endpoints, and retention. Browser controls should be described as deterrence, not a claim that screenshots or copying are impossible.

3.4 Stage 3: Webhooks with a zero-evidence payload rule

Add outbound webhooks only for state transitions: delivery issued, access granted, access denied, expired, revoked, and reissued. The payload must contain delivery metadata and immutable IDs, never evidence rows, raw report content, access tokens, raw recipient addresses, or secrets. Require HTTPS, host allowlists, request signing, replay protection, idempotency keys, retries with bounded backoff, a dead-letter queue, and a per-tenant kill switch.

The current EspoCRM integration is the model: it is separate from RipoDoc's evidence boundaries, consent-gated, HMAC-authenticated, DNS-pinned, and least-data. The live integration remains unproven against a real EspoCRM instance; preserve that distinction.

3.5 Stage 4: Source maps and connectors — validate first

A authoritative source mapping (source map) is strategically attractive because it can reduce recurring authoring work. But it is dangerous: every connector increases credential, tenancy, freshness, and interpretation risk. Do not build a connector catalogue until three design partners request the same source system and can name the authoritative field, capture cadence, approver, scope, and error owner. The first connector should be a constrained, read-only, tenant-isolated integration with a human approval gate before publication.

3.6 Stage 5: AI only as constrained draft assistance

YC's live RFS includes AI-Native Compliance Infrastructure, which seeks operational systems that reduce fragmented tooling and specialist headcount. 9 The adjacent opportunity for RipoDoc is not a generic "AI

compliance assistant." It is a constrained assistant that proposes: a candidate claim, likely source fields, a scope gap, missing review facts, and a draft reader-safe explanation. It must never publish evidence, infer compliance, or make report claims authoritative. Human review remains mandatory.

4 Economics and decision thresholds

4.1 Explicit test-price scenarios

No RipoDoc pricing or commercial performance has been supplied. The figures below are **test-price scenarios**, all in USD, with an assumed 80% US / 20% Australia logo mix. Australia pricing is a planning discount, not observed willingness to pay. They do not justify a valuation.

Scenario	Month-6 logos	Month-6 MRR	Run-rate ARR	Use
Downside	2 US + 1 AU = 3	USD 997	USD 11,964	Fails the USD 1k target by USD 3.
Base test case	10 US + 3 AU = 13	USD 6,277	USD 75,324	A reasonable expansion test target, not a forecast.
Upside	24 US + 6 AU = 30	USD 18,930	USD 227,160	Requires evidence of repeat value, onboarding, and retention before it can guide planning.

At a base test price of USD 499 per US logo and USD 429 per Australian logo, the blended planning price is USD 485. Three paid logos clear USD 1k MRR; eleven clear USD 5k MRR. The economics may look better than Audit A because the offer is broader, but expansion introduces higher implementation cost, longer sales cycles, more risk, and more support burden. **Do not choose the expansion because the spreadsheet is prettier.** Choose it only after a current-product pilot shows that delivery lifecycle pain, not merely claim visibility, is the paid job.

4.2 Market boundary: no invented TAM

The US SBA 2025 profile reports 654,501 businesses with 20–499 employees, while ABS reports 67,857 Australian businesses with 20–199 employees. [10] [11] These are outer-business-universe data, not MSP counts, not RipoDoc customer counts, and not a revenue TAM. A credible bottom-up market model requires a named MSP logo list, segmentation by QBR cadence and source-system complexity, observed price, and a real sales conversion record. Until those exist, market size should be reported as **unmeasured**, not inflated.

5 YC-readiness: improve the story by proving one hard thing

YC's application guidance stresses clarity, specific founder evidence, non-generic insight, a demonstration, and disclosure of obstacles. 12 The strongest RipoDoc application is not "we built AI compliance for MSPs." It is:

> **RipoDoc is the evidence-delivery layer behind MSP client reports. When a client challenges a material claim, it reveals only reviewed support for that claim, to the intended reader, with expiry and a receipt. We started with [named report claim] and proved [measured repeat buyer outcome] across [number] paid MSPs.**

That statement becomes credible only when the bracketed items contain evidence. The RFS provides theme adjacency, not endorsement. YC explicitly says an RFS is not necessary to apply. 9

YC-readiness component	Today	Required proof
Clear company description	Mostly ready	Use the claim-to-proof sentence; remove broad platform language.
Founder evidence	Unknown	Specific demonstrated founder achievements and direct customer insight.
Insight	Promising	Evidence that report narrative versus raw export is a repeat, paid problem.
Product demonstration	Technical demo exists	A production-capable pilot workflow with customer-approved data or safe synthetic data.
Traction	Absent	Five paid design partners, repeat use, continuation, and a measurable buyer outcome.
Defensibility	Emerging	Delivery receipts, source maps, policy layer, and a proprietary corpus of what evidence MSPs use to defend claims—subject to consent and privacy controls.

6 90-day decision programme

Days	Work	Decision-grade evidence
0–15	Production foundation and receipt design	Preflight passes; environment is configured; receipt schema and threat model reviewed; one synthetic end-to-end delivery can be issued, revoked, reissued, and audited.
16–45	Five paid current-product pilots	Each pilot has a report claim, source, recipient, delivery event, client question, price, time-to-answer, and continuation decision.
46–60	Receipt/lifecycle feature release	At least three pilots request lifecycle control or show measurable benefit from it; no raw-evidence leakage in the lifecycle record.

Days	Work	Decision-grade evidence
61–90	Expansion go/no-go	Build webhooks only if at least three MSPs name the same target system and accept a zero-evidence event payload. Build first connector only if the same authoritative source recurs across three paid pilots.

6.1 Kill criteria

Stop or reposition the expansion if any of these happens: fewer than three of five pilots return for a second report cycle; pilots say the existing portal or secure-document tool already solves the job; buyers will not pay even a bounded pilot fee; the buyer cannot name a material claim requiring proof; or the implementation repeatedly requires generic data-room features. These are not failures of engineering. They are evidence that the wedge is too weak or mis-specified.

7 Security boundary for the expansion

The expansion must preserve the current constraints. Evidence and recipient data must not flow into CRM. The receipt must be tenant-isolated and avoid raw-recipient exposure. Webhook events must never contain evidence rows or access tokens. Connector refresh must be read-only, source-specific, and human-reviewed before publication. AI must be assistive and non-authoritative. The product must not claim that controlled delivery creates regulatory compliance, prevents screenshots, or replaces customer governance. The existing project found and repaired a transitive `nanoid` advisory and removed `unsafe-eval` from the production CSP while preserving development support; the full 169-test release gate passed afterward. These are useful hygiene improvements, not an external security certification.

8 Glossary

***CRM* – customer relationship management**: A system used for commercial contacts and sales workflow. In this expansion it receives only explicit-consent lead metadata, never evidence, recipient, token, report, or audit data.

***MRR* – monthly recurring revenue**: Recurring subscription revenue measured per month; used here only for explicitly labelled planning scenarios.

***MSP* – managed service provider**: A technology provider that manages IT services for customer organisations.

***POC* – proof of concept**: A time-boxed validation with a real buyer that tests a named workflow and willingness to pay.

***delivery policy* – evidence-delivery policy**: A tenant-scoped rule set controlling who may receive a proof path, expiry, revocation, watermarking, export policy, and event handling.

***QBR* – quarterly business review**: A recurring MSP-client meeting reviewing service value, risk, priorities, and decisions.

***delivery receipt* – evidence delivery receipt**: An operator-facing immutable record that a specific evidence delivery was issued, accessed or denied, expired, revoked, and reissued under a stated policy.

***source map* – authoritative source mapping**: A reviewed connection between a report claim, its supporting system/source, capture time, owner, and approved evidence boundary.

9 References and basis

No.	Source	Use and limitation
1–4	ScalePad; CloudRadial; Strategy Overview; MSP Report Card	Vendor pages used to define advertised adjacent feature surface, not verified performance.
5	DocSend secure PDF guide	Vendor description of generic secure-document controls.
6	NinjaOne QBR guidance	Vendor/practitioner workflow guide.
7	r/msp practitioner post	Anecdotal pain signal only.
8	RipoDoc live health endpoint	Runtime configuration disclosure observed 18 Aug 2026.
9	YC Requests for Startups	Official RFS context; not funding probability.
10–11	US SBA 2025 profile; ABS business counts	Government outer-universe context; not MSP TAM.
12	YC application guidance	Official application-writing guidance; not a scoring rubric.

Basis and limitations. This report is dated 18 August 2026 (GMT+10). It treats RipoDoc as a private, early-stage project with unverified revenue, customer, retention, and funding data. Every price, logo, MRR, ARR, conversion, timing, cost, and probability figure is a planning scenario or decision threshold, not a factual performance claim. This is research and analysis only, not personalised financial, legal, or investment advice.